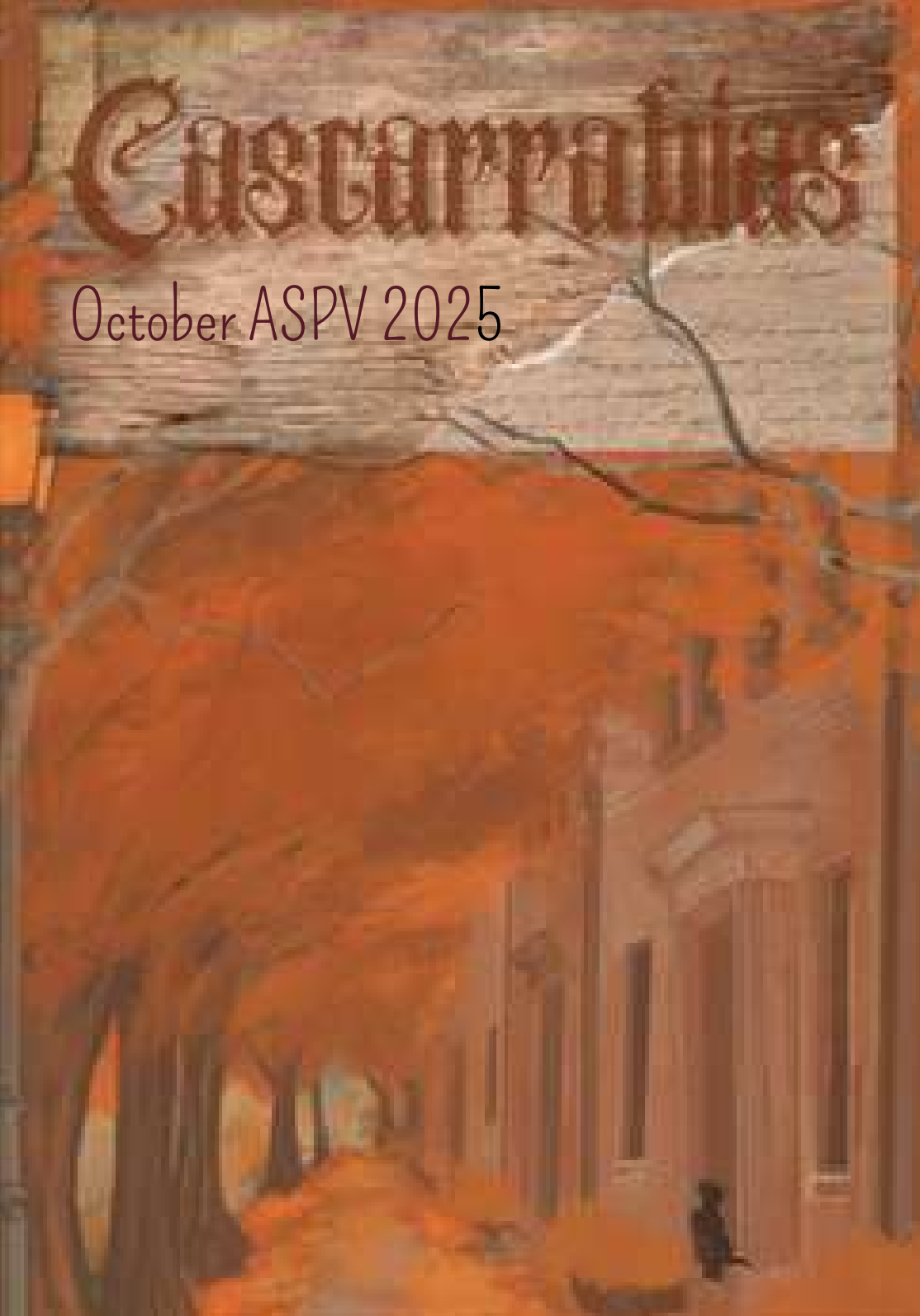


Cascarrabias

October ASPV 2025



Cascarrabras MADE POSSIBLE BY

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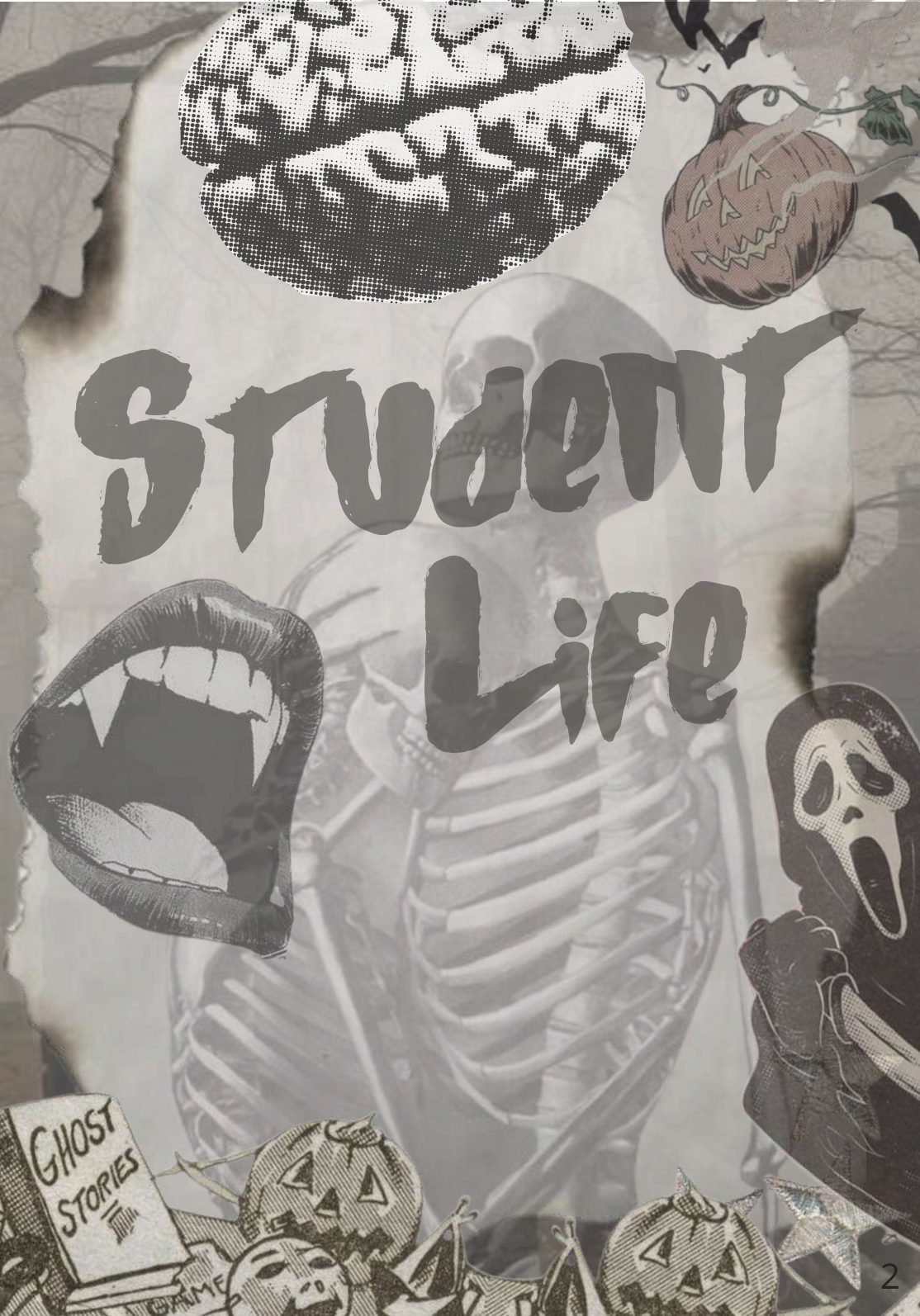
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Student Life



Community Gathering

On October 3, during FLEX time, the Community Gathering elective hosted an event focused on roots: identity, heritage, and values. The goal of the gathering was to highlight the importance of roots as both personal and collective, showing how they shape individuals and communities alike. Roots were described not only as family traditions, cultural practices, or personal experiences, but also as school connections that tie people together in shared identity and belonging.

The event began with an introduction from members of the elective, Dayana Zavalza and Sierra Williamson, who explained the purpose of the class and the meaning of roots, framing the concept as both deeply personal and socially significant. To bring this idea to life, Charlie Higgins, a local musician and ASPV teacher, performed songs that reflected themes of heritage and connections, including *Hasta la Raiz*. The music created a shared atmosphere, using familiar lyrics and melodies to remind the audience of the power of art expressing belonging and memory.

Following the performance, Kaya McCluskey, a Mexican American ASPV parent and artist, described the challenge of navigating two cultural identities. She mentions facing expectations to fit in American life while still holding on to her Mexican heritage. Her grandmother played a central role in shaping her connection to her roots. Inspired by this, she created *Selfies Sagrados*, a reimaged version of the Sacred Heart of Jesus Christ. Instead of the traditional white image often associated with it, she emphasizes the idea of a heart that reflects personal identity. Her project encourages people to create their own versions, showing symbols and depictions that represent who they are and how they view themselves.

The program then included the Shark Report, which delivered regular school updates along with interviews that highlighted teachers' heritages and definitions of identity. These stories emphasize the diversity within our school community and demonstrate that everyone carries unique roots worth recognizing.

The gathering concluded with a musical performance by Mr. Charlie Higgins of *Take Me Home, Country Roads*, where the audience sang along. Though simple, this shared activity served as a symbolic reminder of unity and connection.

Overall, the Community Gathering used music, personal stories, and students' voices to illustrate the significance of roots. The event showed that roots both provide individuality and community, reminding people of where they come from while grounding them in who they are and who they may become.

OCTOBER 3

Community Gathering:
By: Sierra Williamson

Roots

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El Grito
Por: Luna

Por: Luna Orozco

El 15 de septiembre celebramos el Grito de Dolores como símbolo de libertad y orgullo nacional. Nuestra escuela se llenó de colores, música, alegría y sonrisas de las familias que forman parte de la comunidad ASPV.

Varios alumnos de primaria realizaron espectáculos, representando tradiciones mexicanas como bailes folklóricos, actuaciones, mariachi y el floreo de lazo.

El floreo de lazo representa la cultura y tradición mexicanas. Es un símbolo icónico de la charrería, conocida como el deporte nacional de México, también es una herramienta importante para las labores del campo y ganadería. Ha pasado de generación en generación.



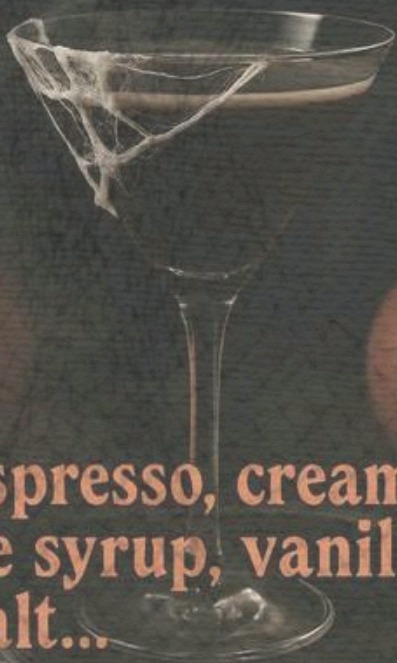
Por: Luna Orozco

EL MARIACHI

El Mariachi es uno de los símbolos de identidad más importantes de México, conocido a nivel mundial. Representa la historia, tradición, alegría y celebración que une los corazones de la gente, tanto dentro como fuera de sus fronteras.

Gracias a la escuela, maestros y familias que formaron parte de esta celebración, que nos permitió convivir, recordar la importancia de la independencia y mantener vivas las tradiciones en las nuevas generaciones.

ESPRESSO MARTINI MOCKTAIL



Mix espresso, cream,
simple syrup, vanilla
and salt...

Then melt marshmallow on
top for a spooky touch!



LIBRARY

News



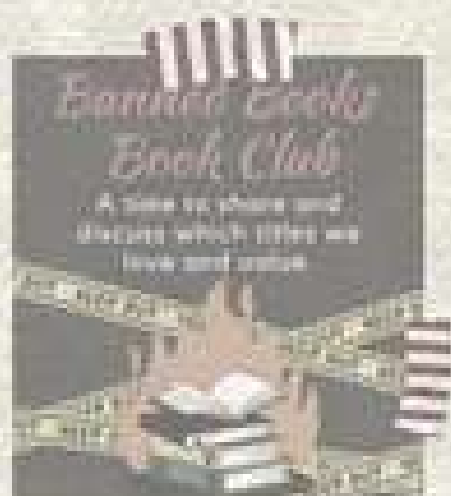
Banned Books

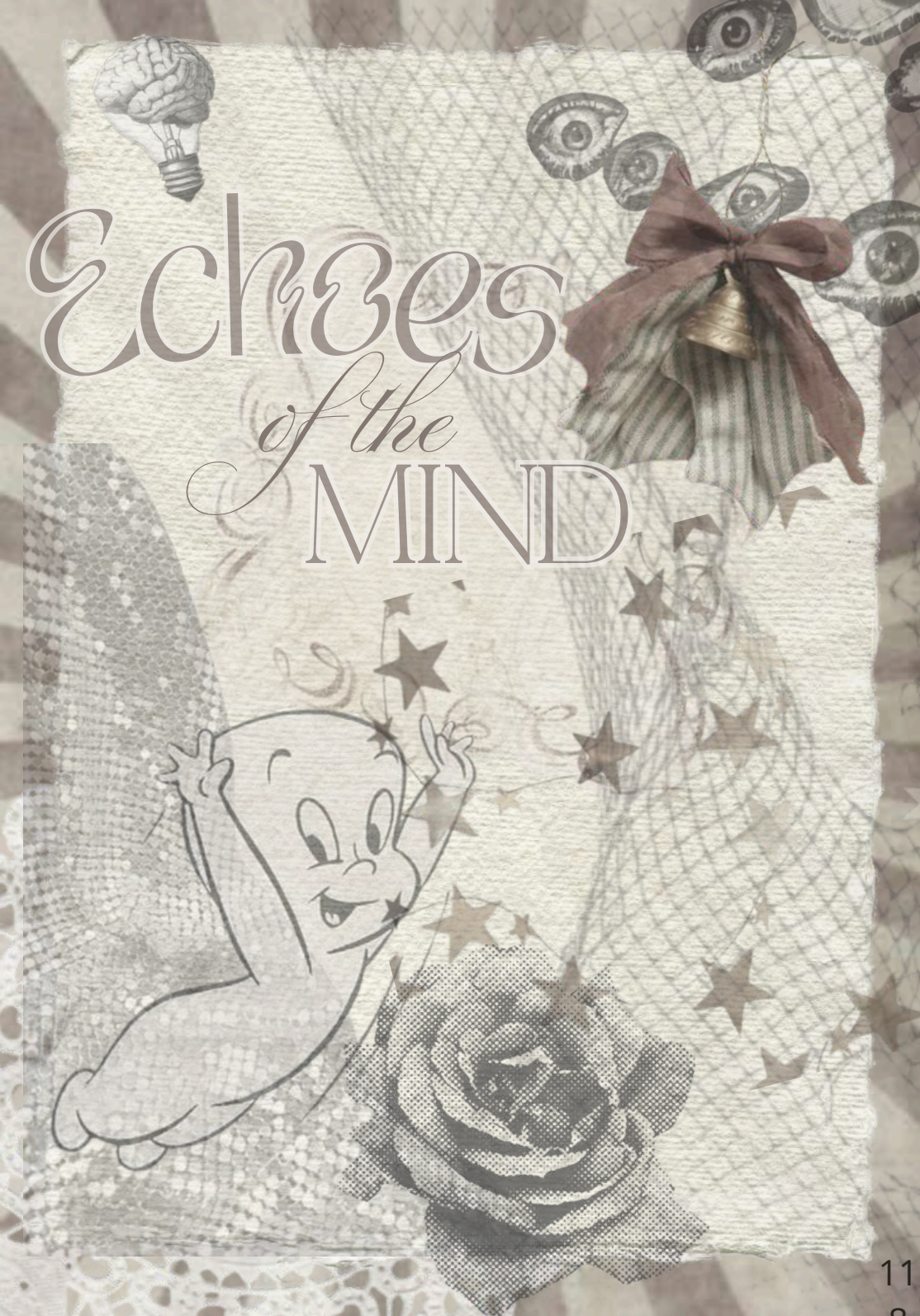
"Give Up To Us 1984. Read for Your Rights."

"With the escalation in attempts to ban books in libraries, schools, and bookstores around the country, George Orwell's cautionary tale 1984 serves a pressing warning about the dangers of censorship. This year's theme reminds us that the right to read belongs to all of us, that censorship has no place in contemporary society, and that we must defend our rights." (American Library Association 2023)

Banned Books Week is an annual event designed to promote freedom of speech and celebrate the diversity of ideas in literature. Our library exists to not only support our academic curriculum but also to provide students with both mirrors and windows. We hope to reflect their own experiences and books that broaden their worldview. Our collection is curated for teenagers, and we hope that we have pushed them to something that they will treasure today. This year, celebrate Banned Books Week and support it all.

During the week, explore the history of book censorship in black libraries, and share the lessons and the freedom of speech. You won't want to miss out on a special edition of *Book Club*. Meet in the library during lunch on Wednesday to discuss which books you love that have been banned in different parts of the world. Then join us Thursday after school in celebration: wear freedom to school, Party's love tag, and decorate it with your favorite books.





Echoes *of the* MIND





I Want to be so Many Things i'm Afraid I become Nothing

By: Athenea Estrada

It's exhausting to be so many versions of ourselves all at once. Some days I wake up feeling like a thousand dreams are all shouting at us, asking to be chosen. I want to be an architect, sketching cities that touch the clouds and designing spaces where sunlight dances through glass. But I also want to be a dance teacher, the kind that inspires little girls to move like joy itself, to believe their bodies can tell stories without the need for words. I want to own a flower shop in a small town where mornings smell like tulips and new beginnings. I want to be a dancer touring the world, losing myself in the rhythm, in movement, in the music of being alive. I want to be a doctor, though not just any doctor, but one who heals the people who suffer daily because they can't afford treatments, who eases the quiet desperation of those stuck between illness and impossible bills. I want to be a writer who finds the right words for feelings no one talks about, a psychiatrist who listens to what silence hides. I want to be an artist. I want to be everything.

But sometimes, wanting everything feels like wanting nothing, like scattering ourselves so thin that we disappear. I envy people who seem sure, who say "I've always known I wanted to be this". I've never had this kind of certainty because my dreams change colors like the sky does in a single afternoon, soft pinks of hope, deep blues of fear, and bursts of gold that vanish too fast. I want to be able to wake up at 5 a.m and run before the sun rises. I want to write for hours in a coffee stained notebook and somehow turn it into a book that makes someone cry in the best way. I want to stay up late in a studio, sweating and with a sore body from dancing. Speak 5 languages. Fix a car. Illustrate a children's book. Walk into a room and say, with confidence "I'm good at this". Therefore, maybe, I just love beginnings, the sparkle of curiosity before it is crunched by expectations.

I sometimes think about fig trees and how they take their time growing slowly, roots sinking deep into the earth before the first leaves even appear. How they bloom in secret, how their fruit is not immediate but worth the wait, sweet, rich, and most importantly, full of life. I want to be like a fig tree in some ways, patient with myself, giving myself permission to grow slowly, to bend and twist in unexpected directions, to take my time figuring out which parts of me will bear fruit and which are just leaves reaching for sunlight. There's a quiet kind of power in that, in being unfinished, in knowing that what you become is not always visible at first, but one day, maybe, all your scattered dreams will taste as sweet as a fig.

There's this invisible timeline everyone seems to follow, graduate, get a job, buy a house, marry, have kids, retire, die. A perfect checklist for life that fits neatly in boxes. But I don't want my life to be tidy, I yearn for it to be full, complicated, a little wild. I don't want to chase checkpoints. I want to chase wonder. I want to travel not because I should, but because the world is too big to stay in one place. I want to learn slowly, fail loudly, and love deeply. I want to take my time figuring things out, to live at my own pace, not the one that the world insists on.

Maybe we're not meant to be just one thing. Maybe no one is. Maybe we are meant to be unfinished, a collection of drafts, half-built dreams, and sparkly pieces of all the lives we could live. Who are we to know what we'll be, after all? I'm young, new, still tasting the world, still learning how deep the rivers run and how tall the mountains can grow. And maybe that's not a failure. Maybe that's freedom. That's life.

How Dress Code Highlights Societies Sexism

By: Sierra Williamson



When you think of the term dress code, what rules come to mind? Skirts and shorts must be as long as your fingertips. No cleavage. No stomach showing. No tight form-fitting clothes. According to the United States Government Accountability Office, 93% of US schools enforce these types of rules, and of those, 90% of prohibited clothing restrictions are aimed directly at girls ("Department of Education Should Provide Information on Equity and Safety in School Dress Codes").

When we look closely at the dress code rules, a clear pattern emerges: the rules targeting female clothing. Bans on spaghetti strap and cleavage are perfect examples that highlight these one sided policies. Nevertheless, this isn't just about the clothing, but about how girls' bodies are viewed. The main reason we are given these restrictions is because our clothing can supposedly cause "distractions." I believe this only exposes the hard truth: women are forced to alter their appearance simply because boys are not taught self control.

Nearly every woman, at some point in their life, has unfortunately experienced a form of sexual harassment, whether its physical or verbal. Not only do these dress code rules sexualize high school girls, it blames them for getting the boys' attention. You'd never blame a person who got robbed for "leaving their door unlocked", so why are girls blamed when boys can't control themselves? These rules don't just target our clothing; they target our identity, confidence, and the way we are allowed to exist in our own bodies.

Even my own school's dress code shows these same problems. For example, during spirit days the policy bans "inappropriate outfits," which are defined as clothes that are "not modest, contain offensive messaging, are not in good taste, or not costume appropriate." The issue here is vague wording: what exactly does "fit appropriately" or "in good taste" really mean? Unlike specific rules such as fingertip length, these phrases are left open to interpretation, which makes them easy to enforce unfairly. The policy also states that outfits should be "modest," but that word is just as unclear. And while it doesn't call our gender directly, we all know that when modesty is mentioned, it's usually girls who are targeted and judged.

These restrictions affect all women, but have disproportionately targeted those with curvier body types. Even if two girls are wearing similar, even identical, pieces of clothing, one girl might have an unfair scrutiny due to her body type. That's deeply discriminatory, oppressing young girls and fostering shame about their natural bodies.

When a student violates a dress code, consequences can include changing into uniform, detention, and even in some cases, suspension. Girls are not only losing valuable class time but also facing serious punishment for simply wearing an item of clothing. A system that is supposedly designed to promote learning is only disrupting girls' class time by belittling them. Moreover, this injustice goes on beyond school walls—it connects with our society.

On a broader spectrum, these sexist injustices appear in workplace dress codes, harassment culture, and victim blaming. Rather than teaching young boys and men to respect women, we instead are taught to accept unequal treatment as normal. I, along with countless women around the world, are noticing this injustice and are fighting back.

Across the U.S., students have started to push back against unfair dress codes. Girls and boys alike have protested, started petitions, and demanded changes that focus on comfort and equality rather than policing female bodies. Schools that have introduced gender neutral and more flexible dress policies show how it's possible to maintain respect and order without targeting girls. When students are treated equally in a classroom, it sets a standard for equality in society, teaching everyone that fairness shouldn't stop at school doors.

In the end, the dress code shouldn't control how girls express themselves. They distract from learning and make anyone ashamed of their bodies. The problem isn't girls' clothing. It's the outdated rules that disrupt learning. By rethinking these policies, schools can finally create spaces where everyone can learn, grow, and feel respected.

The Code

By Ruby and Oswin

I will never give up.
I will take care of my
mental health.
I will always love my
family.
I will be strong.
I will stand up for
whats right
I will accomplish all
my goals
I will have
determination
I will always try
I will create

I will love.
I will have
determination.
I will focus on what I
am grateful for.
I will finish what I
started.
I will be
understanding.
I will be myself.
I will always try.
I will be good.





Las Calaveritas

Ms Brenda Hernandez

Miss Jen

Era un 4 de septiembre
cuando Jen lo decidió
“Me voy a probar suerte
a una nueva nación”
sin saber lo que el destino,
a su corazón le preparó...

Así con un par de sueños
su maleta acomodó,
y justo en ese momento
la Calaca presintió
que de Michigan llegaba
ya su nueva “posesión”

Y después de cinco horas
el avión aterrizó
en un hermoso Pueblito
que a la Jen enamoró ...
“Bienvenida a este Puerto
I

Ya saliendo del aeropuerto
el calor la acechó,
pero no había vuelta de hoja
su aventura comenzó
su futuro estaba escrito
pongan todos atención:
¡Una linda americana,
a nuestro colegio llegó!
pa’ enseñar a sus alumnos
nuevo idioma o qué sé yo,
la materia ya no importa
pero sí lo que impactó,
pues grandes alumnos tuvo
y se quedaron en su corazón.

La Catrina la observaba
con muchísima atención
no creía que fuera cierto
lo que ella entonces vio:
esa linda extranjera
unos tacos se pidió,
un buen chai para bajarlos
sobre todo, del picor
chocolatito muy caliente
como postre remató.

ra un 4 de septiembre
cuando Jen lo decidió
“Me voy a probar suerte
a una nueva nación”
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su maleta acomodó,
y justo en ese momento
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que de Michigan llegaba
ya su nueva “posesión”

Y después de cinco horas
el avión aterrizó
en un hermoso Pueblito
que a la Jen enamoró ...
“Bienvenida a este Puerto
la Flaca le susurró”
ni enterada en el momento
pues español no entendió...

Ya saliendo del aeropuerto
el calor la acechó,
pero no había vuelta de hoja
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como postre remató.



Mr. OTTO

Este día toca hablar
de una persona singular
De Porto Alegre me complace,
¡A Don Otto presentar!
Brasileño de nacimiento,
miren quien lo iba a decir
que en México encontró momento,
pa' venirse a residir,
aquí la Flaca lo espera
ella ya, lo veía venir...

Y aquí con su hermosa familia
Otto Neitzel se instaló
trabajando en el Americano
como el nuevo Director
en la sección de primaria
a todos impresionó
llegó con la pila puesta
que hasta al baile ya le entró
los machetes demostraron
nuestra buena adquisición
y la Calaca emocionada
desde el palco le aplaudió...

Con su hermosa esposa Scheila
la aventura emprendió
y aunque el mismo continente
el idioma conflictuó,
¿inglés, español cuál es el bueno?
la Huesuda cuestionó,
Una voz muy firme dijo:
es "portaño!" lo afirmó yo...

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es "portaño!" lo afirmó yo...

Calaverita a Miss Amy

Francesca Quisenberry

Un día la muerte llegó al centro,
tocó despacio, entró muy lento...
Buscaba a Miss Amy, llena de color
porque ella enseñaba,
con todo su amor

Amy pintaba con sus gatos al lado.
Todos maullando muy preocupados
"Voy con la muerte", dijo al pasar
"pero primero, voy a saludar"

Corrió a la escuela, con paso ligero
sus alumnos vieron con gran
desespero
"Adiós mis chiquillos, sigan creando,
que yo desde lejos, los sigo
observando"

Y cuentan que en clase,
cuando hay un silencio
se oyen maullidos
y risas al viento

La Muerte sonríe
cada vez que ve,
que Amy en el arte,
sigue de pie ...

(La Calaca artística)

Miss Amy muy enfadada
a sus alumnos regaló
a la Dama Delgada,
eso no le pareció

Así que en ese momento
para arte acudió,
Miss Amy al verla parada
casi un infarto le dió

La Llorona su salón le destrozó
preguntando por qué su imagen,
ella nunca dibujó
y Miss Amy muy de prisa
a la Calaca ilustró
a ver si la perdonaba
pa'no irse al panteón

"Hey friend listen to me"
te lo pido por favor
"Gift me white one minute"
pa'decirles adiós...

Jacobo Stone

UNA Eglaverita a Miss Carol

Ina López

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porque ella enseñaba,
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cuando hay un silencio
se oyen maullidos
y risas al viento

La Muerte sonríe
cada vez que ve,
que Amy en el arte,
sigue de pie ...

CALAVERITA A

Miss Jen

Marjorie Aguilar

En la escuela
Americano,
todo iba bien
hasta que la Flaca,
llegó también

Buscaba a Jen,
con gran emoción
pues ella quería,
llevarla al panteón

Directora buena y
trabajadora
Le dijo la Muerte
a esta señora,
“vente conmigo,
no te demoras”

La Miss logró
responder:
“Ay no puede ser,
pues yo tengo hijos
a quién proteger”

La Parca sonrió,
ven, solo un ratito
así nos enseñas,
de todo un poquito

Miss Jen no dudo
en ayudar
pero de repente
¡la vimos volar!



Calaverita

Era un rey

Calaverita
para mi perro Papa

Él era un rey
un amante y emperador
decidía la ley
y era en secreto, “matador”

En el sillón de mi casa,
roncaba el dormilón
soñando con su vida buena:
tocino y jamón

Sentó en su trono
y él mirando su mucho dinero
sabía que no había ningún otro
que tuviera el mundo entero

Vino la Flaca risueña,
y el perrito despertó
con paso firme y sin prisa
Ella, lo saludó

Hasta que un día
con la Calaca se encontró
sintió su mano fría,
y su sonrisa, lo abandonó

“Levántate flojo amigo,
que el banquete ya empezó,
hay tamal y pan de muerto”
¡y hasta atole se sirvió!

“Has hecho mucho chico,
pero tu tiempo ya acabó”
y él a ella dijo:
¡No puedes! ¡te pagaré!
te haré muy rica Flaca
lo juro que cumpliré

El perrito muy curioso
a la Huesuda siguió
entre risas y calacas
¡su sueño eterno encontró!

Pero así con dinero
tu propiedad y poder
a la muerte no serás extranjero
y de la tierra, volverás a ser

Maya Slobe

Willy King



Cataverita

Miss Brenda H.

Sarah Silva

La Catrina fue a la escuela,
con su cuaderno y su lista
quería ver a Miss Brenda
la Miss más risueña y lista

Siempre llega muy temprano
ni la Muerte la puede igualar
pues mientras ella daba clase
la Flaca comenzó a estudiar

Pero Brenda con su chiste
hizo a la huesuda reír
y entre risas y carcajadas
se olvidó de su venir

“Hoy no te llevo” dijo la Muerte
“Me caíste muy bien, maestra mía”
mejor quédate enseñando,
y alegrando tu clase, cada día.

Miss Daniela

(La Pelona en clase de Español)

La Pelona esperó tocando la puerta,
la cual abrió, una maestra contenta
Al entrar vio alumnos de octavo grado
ahí estaba Macedo, él, era su aliado

La Miss le preguntó,
¿A qué viene su visita?
Ella le respondió:
Su clase hoy finiquita

¡Señora Catrina, bella eres
hazme un favor si puedes,
permíteme darles tarea!
se lo pidió con mucho amor

La Flaca esperó
y la maestra aprovechó
la última tarea dejó:
Es que sean amables, por favor

La Huesuda la agarró
y sin decir nada, se la llevó
a lo lejos se sonrió
pues a su perrito, también vió.

Santiago Macedo

Calaverita

MISS CAIT

MISS CAIT

Bien lo dijo un día Chavela:
el mexicano tiene opción
“de nacer ‘onde le plazca”
¡y esta vez sí sucedió!
que una linda paisanita
fue que ella se aprontó,
pa’ llegar allá en el Norte,
Y “Morehead” fue la elección.
Y es así como comienza
de “Peanut” su razón
pa’ elegir ser mexicana
(lo traía en su corazón)

Hace más de diez años
quién lo iba a imaginar,
que una bella jovencita
aquí se iba a enamorar
nos contaba a detalle
esta historia sin igual
la Catrina emocionada
por lo que iba a relatar...

Es que ella cuando “viva”
también a la jungla amó
entre bellas guacamayas
pues en un jardín voló,
y con muchos animales
jella siempre convivió!
es por eso que ahora
le gana la emoción
de ver a Cait sembrando
con amor y devoción
pa’ dejar un mejor mundo,
mejor de como lo encontró.

La Calaca continuaba “Pero, ¿Cómo la llevo al más allá?
con su historia singular”
yo pensé “de sentimientos,
nunca a nadie le iba a hablar”
hoy mejor no escribo nada
y la dejo continuar...

“Me gusta a la gente
llevarme al panteón
a cementerios o tumbas
lo disfruto yo ...
Aunque déjame decirte
que tengo un raro placer
y a muchas personas
yo las dejo envejecer ...
pues a este planeta
vienen todos a ayudar
a ser sustentables
¡Ese, era el plan!

cuál es la misión
amar animales,
es buena la opción
Vivir en la jungla
es un gran placer
que pocas personas
pueden entender”...

Todo eso externaba
con tal devoción
que tal parecía
le debía un favor
y así continuaba
con gran impresión:

de buenos pambazos,
¡que quisiera probar!
Hay duendes y gatos
caballitos de mar,
lindos los jardines
que vas a encontrar ...
A Metate y a Chianti
me encanta espiar
cuando hacen maldades
¡al pobre de Iván!”

Y por eso te digo
cómo ahí se contó
lo que la hermosa Catrina
nos compartió:
“Allá en su Vallarta
le extendió el reloj
pues aún falta mucho
pa traerla al panteón...

le faltan otoños que completar
Abriles de cumpleaños, por celebrar
Que Sansa y Ada me pueden juzgar
de ser muy muy mala
si falta mamá,

será Molcajete quién me pueda ver
un día que baje como aquella vez
vestida de duende de frente quedé
con esa linda persona, es bella mujer

Miss Cait la conocen, que grato el placer” ...

Terminó de contarnos
la Señora Blanca,
dejando en nosotros
una gran esperanza
que vale la pena,
seguir por senderos,
que el día de muertos
¡Se acerca, nos vemos!

THE MISS

Calaverita

Era un 4 de septiembre
cuando Jen lo decidió
"Me voy a probar suerte
a una nueva nación"
sin saber lo que el destino,
a su corazón le preparó...

Así con un par de sueños
su maleta acomodó,
y justo en ese momento
la Calaca presintió
que de Michigan llegaba
ya su nueva "posesión"

Y después de cinco horas
el avión aterrizó
en un hermoso Pueblito
que a la Jen enamoró ...
"Bienvenida a este Puerto
la Flaca le susurró"
ni enterada en el momento
pues español no entendió...

Ya saliendo del aeropuerto
el calor la acechó,
pero no había vuelta de hoja
su aventura comenzó
su futuro estaba escrito
pongan todos atención:
¡Una linda americana,
a nuestro colegio llegó!
pa' enseñar a sus alumnos
nuevo idioma o qué sé yo,
la materia ya no importa
pero sí lo que impactó,
pues grandes alumnos tuvo
y se quedaron en su corazón.

La Catrina la observaba
con muchísima atención
no creía que fuera cierto
lo que ella entonces vio:
esa linda extranjera
unos tacos se pidió,
un buen chai para bajarlos
sobre todo, del picor
chocolatito muy caliente
como postre remató.
Bienvenida a la tierra,
que desde siempre te adoptó
Y aunque sé que de repente
no podemos reemplazar,
a tu hermoso estado Michigan,
te lo vengo yo a contar:
que en cultura, amor y gente
parecido hay un lugar
de montañas y hartos lagos
ve a pasear por Michoacán
cuando al otoño extrañes
paz ahí vas a encontrar...
La Huesuda recitaba
con encanto singular,
ella se había dado cuenta
que la Jen se iba a quedar
a formar una gran familia
¡decidida estaba ya!

Ya Pale hizo gran entrada
lográndola conquistar
con Elia y Dylan de la mano
un futuro cierto hay

Así que escucha hermosa Flaca
algo hoy te pido yo,
déjala aquí un tiempo,
muchos años de favor
que una buena Directora
ASPV designó
pa' ayudar a los alumnos
que requieren su atención
¡de sus cuidados, de consejos
y también de su amor!

De eso se trata la vida
de mirar a los demás
que de paso estamos todos
y buena huella hay que dejar...



Waltzing with the Willis

By: Athenea Estrada

There's something hauntingly beautiful about Giselle. Maybe it's the music that sounds like a memory, or the way the dancers seem to float between love and loss. I watched it for the first time last weekend, and I can't stop thinking about the Wilis, those ghostly spirits of betrayed brides who rise at midnight to dance men to death. Creepy, right? But also... Strangely romantic.

The Wilis aren't monsters, their heartbreak turned into movement. They wear white gowns and flowers in their hair, shimmering like mist over moonlit forest. When they dance, it isn't just revenge, its release. Watching them, I felt like they weren't punishing life for ending too soon, but reclaiming it in their own eerie graceful way.

Giselle, herself, is so tender and human that it hurts. She dies of heartbreak after discovering her lover's betrayal, yet when she becomes a Wili, she protects him from their deadly dance. That scene when she forgave him, her arms like wings, her ghostly figure glowing with mercy, made me emotional. Since i understood its not just about love after death, but about love, even broken, can still choose kindness.

Maybe that's what Halloween stories should remind us of, that ghosts aren't only there to scare us. Sometimes they're there to remind us to feel, to dance even when our hearts are heavy, to forgive even when we could haunt.

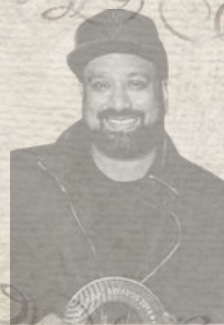
As the curtain fell, the Willis faded back into the forest, and the stage went dark. But I swear, for just a moment, it felt like they were still there, spinning softly in the air, waltzing with forgiveness, with memory, with the audience, and with me.

Behind the Music:

An interview with Dinesh Wicks

BY MARIA IBARRA

When you hear the immense drama of *MasterChef*, the heartwarming notes of *Love on the Spectrum*, or the tension in *SharkTank*, chances are you are hearing the work of Dinesh Wicks, an Australian composer whose music has shaped some of the most iconic shows on TV. But behind the success is a man who simply describes himself as “creative.” For Dinesh, creativity is not limited to music: it’s a way of life. Whether it’s cooking, storytelling, or collaborating with others, he finds joy in sharing his ideas and connecting with others. For him, music became his main channel for that kind of expression.



Dinesh Wicks, nine-time winner of a APRA AMCOS Screen Music Award for Most Performed Composer, is a 50-years-old Sri Lankan music producer who was raised in Sydney, Australia. His journey in music began at 14 years old, when he bought a drum machine and started experimenting with it. Two years later, his father’s friends were already impressed by his sound. Since then, he began writing music for rock bands, but in his early 30’s, a new door opened when he pitched an idea for a show that was quickly endorsed. That led him to writing music for bigger companies, like Disney Channel and National Geographic, before transitioning into scripted dramas and eventually, reality shows. That turning point came with *MasterChef*, what he describes as “the biggest cooking show in the world.” His compositions became the pillar of the franchise across the globe, from Mexico to Thailand, from Ukraine to the US, creating more than 8,000 pieces of music. Still, he admits his favorite project is “*Love on the Spectrum*,” a Netflix reality TV show which filmmaker J.J. Abrams once called one of the most beautiful shows he had ever seen. For Dinesh, it was the perfect example of how love and music can connect people in wholehearted ways.

When it comes to composing, Dinesh’s process always begins with tempo. He studies the scene and decides whether it calls for tension, joy, suspense, or fear. From there, he lays down a percussion rhythm, usually the drums, before finding the melody that matches the emotion. He compares music to an invisible narrator, one that tells the audience what is really happening beneath the surface. To illustrate the point, he brings up *Jaws*: “You never see the shark at first, but the music makes you know he’s coming.” For him, that is the essence of film scoring, music turning even the quietest scene into something memorable.

Despite his love for creating, Dinesh admits it can be difficult to enjoy his own music casually. “When I’m watching something I’ve scored, I can’t switch off. It’s like waiting outside the bathroom and just analyzing everything,” he jokes. Still, there are magical moments when he feels a rush and pride when a piece of his comes together and perfectly transforms a show.

Some of his lesser known projects are among his most meaningful ones. He highlights *Portrait of a Postman*, a documentary about a Memphis postal worker who designed outfits for Hermes and even the Queen, but stopped painting after his son was mixed up in a robbery that got him executed. The heartbreaking story, which won awards in New York and Louisiana, is the project Dinesh says he is most proud of, one that consistently leaves audiences in tears.

His creativity sometimes leads to unusual techniques. For a Muay Thai film, he and a co-composer, who was also a professional fighter, recorded her kicks and punches and turned them into percussion. "It made the music feel authentic to the story," he reflects. Beyond quirky methods, he also loves to leave small musical signatures in many of his shows, such as his favorite, a guitar bend, like in *Sea Patrol*, or a specific cymbal sound that appears throughout *MasterChef*. These small details, he explains, are his way of stamping each project with a unique identity.

If he hadn't chosen music, Dinesh believes he would have pursued law or criminal psychology. Fascinated by the human mind and empathy, he once studied the subject before music became his career path. Even now, he admits he is drawn to anything involving people's traits, motives, and personalities.

Throughout his career, he has collaborated with many artists, but he recalls his funniest experiences with Mark Gable of the Australian band *Choirboys*. "He never takes anything seriously. One moment he's singing obscenities, and the next he's joking around or showing up drunk to a function. He was even the MC at my wedding. He's hysterical," Dinesh recalls with a laugh.

Outside of work, his tastes are refreshingly down to earth. He confesses a love for country songs like Luke Combs' "Ain't no love in Oklahoma," admits to being an early bird rather than a night owl, and says his dream collaboration would be with legendary producer Rick Rubin. His go-to studio snack is a savory pie, and if his life had a soundtrack, he says it would be the opening theme song of *Miami Vice*. If a movie were ever made about his life, he imagines Jamie Foxx would play him, someone who can balance both comedy and seriousness.

The advice he gives for students dreaming of a career in music is candid: "A career in music is not a straight line. It's a squiggly line, with ups and downs, but if you keep working, you'll become so good at what you do that you won't fail. And if you love it, you'll enjoy it, even if you have to do it for free."

Finally, as for the moment he realized he "made it" in the industry, he doesn't point to a single time. His career has had both triumphs and setbacks, but one milestone that stands out in his career was the moment he won the award for most performed composer across half the world. Even then, he doesn't like to measure success in fixed terms. For him, it all comes back to the same impulse that started at age 14, an endless desire to create, to share, and to keep the music alive.



The Weight

by Sierra Williamson

of Time

The clock moves forward
whether I'm ready or not.
I don't feel older,
just different.

Each year adds something
I can't quite name
not wrinkles,
not heaviness,
but a quiet kind of depth.

I ask myself
where I'm going,
who I'm becoming.
But I don't feel lost.
I feel curious.

Memories follow me,
some warm,
some sharp.

They remind me
I have lived,
I am living.

Time isn't an enemy.
It's a teacher.

It's showing me
that growth is not a race,
that becoming myself
is slow,
but steady.





Poemas de 9o

Los alumnos de 9o. Estudiaron el romance, una composición poética popular, típicamente española hecha para ser cantada. Al final, escribieron sus propios romances, pero con una perspectiva contemporánea

Romance del Invierno

Leonardo Hernández

Nieve cae hermosamente,
ya me envuelve el frío duro,
siento una paz muy sensual,
al saber que ya estuvo.

El otoño terminó,
los árboles quedan mudos,
el río se congeló
y tiembla el bosque desnudo.

La luna brilla en lo alto,
su resplandor frío y puro,
corazones congelados,
y el mundo quedó sin rumbo.

Canción

Ayisha Niederkorn

Oigo una linda canción
La mañana en esplendor
Bonitos atardeceres
Mariposas en la flor

Los días se alargan hoy
Por meses hará calor
Sin el canto de aquel
Que a mi vida da color

Así tendré que vivir
Sin esperanza y dolor.

Romance de la Primavera
Valentina Avelar

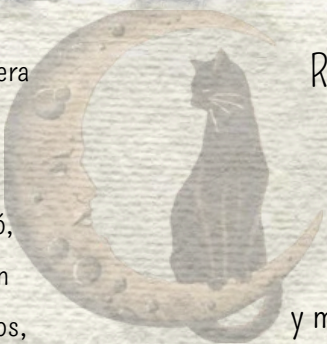
El hielo en agua tornó,
animales despertaron
mojados, pero contentos,
de sus casa emergieron.

Pájaros llegan a casa,
el sol quiere calentar,
es como un cálido abrazo
de mañana al despertar.

Olores frescos y suaves,
el campo vuelve a brillar:
el color regresó al mundo
después de tanto esperar.

Árboles llenos de flores,
colorida vestimenta:
el sol juega con las hojas
remarcando la silueta.

Pétalos llenos de gozo
alegran mucho este día
como miles de sonrisas
despiertan la armonía



Romance de la danza
Lía Quezada (9o.)

La música se oía,
y mis pies se alegraban,
al sentir la melodía,
mi corazón sonreía.

El escenario llamaba,
y mi sueño se encontraba.
Yo vivo así en cada Grito,
mi alma se desataba.

Bailando yo olvido todo,
la pena ya se alejaba,
cada vez mi corazón
con gran fuerza se expresaba.

Esta vida es un bailable,
la música vivirá,
Mi corazón él tendrá.
La melodía quedará,
conmigo caminará.

Oda al cubo Romance de de Rubik la tarea

Emiliano Ruiz

Me encanta el cubito:
es multicolor ado
él es como un monito,
se pone muy pesado.

Lo raro es que es duro,
es como una manzana,
es como un muro duro,
manchado de banana.

Su color brillará,
con sus seis lindos lados.
Al decir de él para
sus lados tapizados.

Linda Ríos

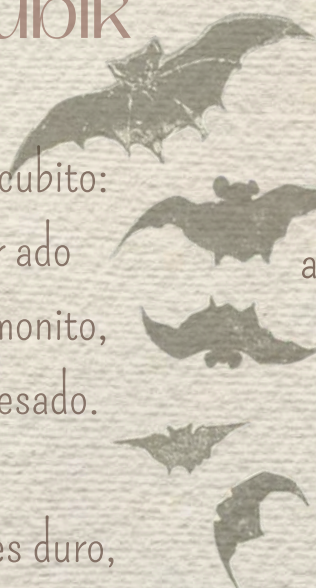
Juego con mucha alegría,
apenas el sol saldrá.

Las flores quieren brillar,
las aves quieren volar

Niños salen a jugar,
no nos importa el
lugar:

al salón nos van a enviar
la tarea llegará.

Los papás ayudarán
entre gritos y algo más
Los papás se desesperan.
Jugar se cancelará.



En la clase de Literatura Universal, que se estudia en 8º. grado, los alumnos reflexionaron sobre el sentido figurado. A partir de los signos del Zodiaco, crearon adivinanzas. Los siguientes son algunos ejemplos.

Soy una caja o baúl
Siempre voy de azul
No me puedes tocar
Solo puedes observar.

Mateo
Garcia
Acuerio

"Al final del verano mis alas se alzan,
con brisa de otoño mis pasos se
marcan.
Soy ángel de tierra, guardián del
detalle,

constante y sereno, jamás me distrae.
De agosto a septiembre mi estrella
verás,
"Qué signo del zodiaco responderás?"
Benito Aguilar

Virgo

Soy signo de tierra con cuernos
de cabra,
Entre diciembre y enero cumplo
mi palabra.

Constante y paciente, mi meta
es llegar,

"Quién soy si en enero me gusta
brillar?"

Lisa Pomina
Capricornio

Un jinete cabalgando,
buscando un nuevo
comienzo.

Mitad hombre, mitad
caballo

"Cuidado! Que tal vez te
disparo...
Camia Zayas

Sagitario

Nado en dúo por el mar de los
sueños,
sigo la marea y siento los
sentimientos ajenos.
Si me buscas en el zodiaco,
verás mi par:
uno va hacia adentro y el otro a
navegar.
"Quién soy?"
Mirko Agnesi

Gemini

Me encuentras en la noche
oscura
con una mirada fuerte y profunda.
Soy intenso, leal y no me vendo,
con mi veneno me defiendo.
Soy de agua, pero también del
calor.

Si te veo, te pico.
Isabella Ramos

Escorpión



Viernes de partida

Respiro hondo antes de que pite,
Mi cuerpo poco a poco se enciende,
Todos enfocados, unos miran hacia enfrente,
Otros gritan y se hacen presentes.

Cuando comienza, todo es intensidad,
La cancha, llena de competitividad.
Choques y barridas, jugamos con ardor,
Cada jugada es sin temor.
Corro y presiono sin parar,
La meta es disfrutar y ganar.

El cansancio llega, las piernas no responden,
Algunos brillan y otros se esconden.
Cada minuto de esfuerzo se notó,
Porque dentro del campo mi vida se dio.
El árbitro pita, el encuentro termina,
La rivalidad se queda atrás en una esquina.
Recogemos todo y vamos por tacos,
Listos para el siguiente viernes con más fut y más tacos.

Felicidad

Felicidad me llaman

Amarilla soy

Y mi pelo rubio es.

Si pasas por mi lado

Quizás te llegue un olor a helado

y hasta escuches un suave

ruido a campanas. si no me encuentras

Ya sabes donde buscar

En un parque O dulcería

me puedes encontrar,

Soy risa, a veces compartida o quizás solitaria

Pero siempre viva.

En compañía de amigos siempre estoy

De eso no cabe duda.

Al tocar mi piel

cosquilleos sentirán.

Por: Anónimo



Mucho mayor ya soy

En una casa de descanso vivo

Pero no pienses que soy decaída

¡Eso sí nunca!

Si en compañía mía estás

Y siempre escucharas

En especial cuando es hora

De hacer aquaerobics.

Tengo una hermana

Y una familia muy abundante.

Así que pasa visitarme

Filas hacen

Y cuando vienen

Soy la alegría en persona.



Why

By : *Anónimo*

Why?

Why is it that even though I try my hardest,
it never ends up working?

Why is it that even though I go every single day to train,
my horse still gets hurt?

I try to persevere, and get back up despite my multiple falls.
But no matter how desperately I try to keep on moving forward,
Nothing seems to work.

Why is it that every time my horse gets better, she ends up hurting once again?

Why does it seem there's no way for me to keep on advancing?

Why does it seem so impossible?

I want to compete again, I want to jump high again, I want to fly again.

So why, oh why, does it seem like that's a goal that I'll never be able to reach once
more?

People say I'm determined, but is that really true when I constantly doubt myself?

They've told me im good when they see me jump, but can they really say the same
when they see the period of time I've been sunk?

Why is it that even though I go every single day to train,
my horse still gets hurt?

Why is it that even though I try my hardest,
it never ends up working?

Why?



Otra vez

Por: Anónimo

Inspirado en el poema de Jericho Brown

Otra vez.

Otra Vez ese asfixiante sentimiento

De mordirme las uñas.

Habita en mí, en exámenes o exposiciones

terca sobre su despedida

Simplemente se rehúsa a irse.

Otra vez busco una solución,

Con las uñas postizas dejo de morder.

Pasa el mes, y al retirarlas sonrío

Mis uñas han crecido,

Se ven bien

Ese sentimiento asfixiante no regresa

Estoy aliviada,

La batalla ha terminado al fin.

Pasa el tiempo

Me peino

Mi uña se astilla

Y regresa esa necesidad

junto con ese hábito

que creí haberse ido.

Otra vez.



DESPUÉS de la lluvia

Por: Anónimo

El canto de las aves me marca un camino,
La selva vallartense me atrae con cariño.
Los árboles me cubren con su sombra,
Todo florece y mi alrededor me asombra.
Desde lo alto veo el paisaje,
Va a valer la pena este viaje.

De pronto el cielo se cubre de gris,
La lluvia cae y no sé si estar feliz.
Los ríos abren sus caminos,
Y el día tiene un nuevo destino.
Me refugio viendo Netflix en casa,
Y descanso mientras todo pasa.

Amanece claro, el sol despierta,
El aire huele a tierra nueva.
Las olas llaman desde lejos,
El cielo es un azul perfecto.
La arena brilla bajo mis pies,
Y el mundo despierta otra vez.

Rachel Lanseros

Basado en un poema de Raquel Lanseros

Por: Sierra Williamson

Dientes muy amarillos decoran a estos hombres.

No sonríen, no hablan: son estatuas.

Tantos somos,

Tres mil cincuenta y siete.

Tengo manos temblorosas y movimientos lentos.

Idéntico a un animal acorralado.

Mi terror va contra un silencio

Que nuestro silencio arquea el depresivo futuro.

Tenéis suerte -mi papá dice

Si estuviera mi madre,

Nunca permitiría que me hicieron esto

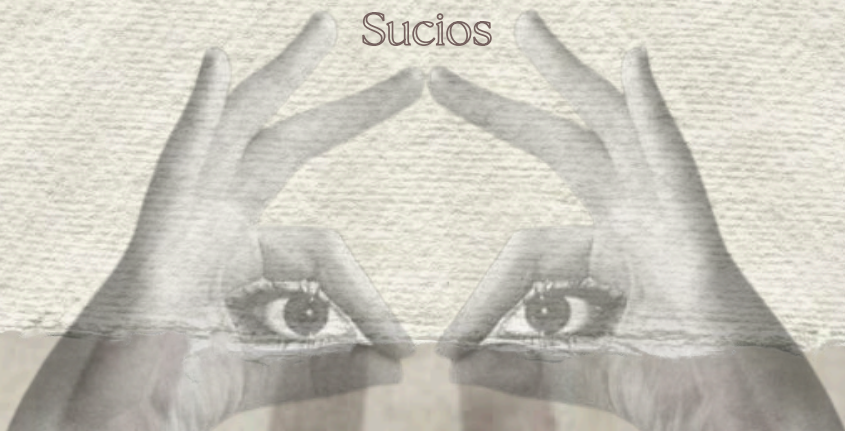
Caer como gotas en una tormenta.

Los viejos somos muchos.

Dicen que olemos terrible.

Que somos..

Sucios



Scrambled Words

Por David Ramos

I couldn't breathe

I couldn't think

I couldn't speak

I was as slow as a snail.

In my bed lying, I wish I could be now.

SLAM!! The door shut

SQUEAK!! The fork scratched against the plate in the kitchen downstairs

The wind went WOOOO as I looked down at my homework on a cloudy, rainy day.

You're like filth stuck in my shoe,

Something unwanted I cannot get rid of.

You're the terror in my dreams

That I simply can't unthink about

I hear my brother yelling as loud as an American Eagle on the Fourth of July.

He was in the living room when he suddenly heard a THUD from the other room.

He runs up to me:

Hey! Can I borrow your phone?

I need to make a call to mom.

My phone doesn't work after many falls

I have pain in my brain, my brain has so much pain.

I could feel myself getting drowsy the more I think.

I tried to finish my work, but I was running out of time

Slowly snuggling myself into bed.

You are my daily bread

My pillows always hide from me as I fall asleep

Mom lets me go to sleep when school starts.

That's why I was late.

Por Emiliano Ruiz

Aburrimiento.

No sé qué hacer,
No tengo hermanos ni hermanas.
Si tuviera amigos
Tal vez tendría algo que hacer.
No tengo nada de entretenimiento.

Soy un adolescente.
No hago deportes
Porque todos me aburren
Y no me llaman la atención.
Los que raramente me hablan
Me dicen que soy aburrido
Y que no sé cómo tener
Una conversación.

No es mi culpa
Que nada me entretenga.
Raramente hablo con gente,
Y no participo mucho
En grupo
Se me hace aburrido intentar.
Cuando intento concentrarme,
Termino perdiendo el interés
Que tuve al iniciar.
Diría que la escuela
Es el lugar que me aburre más.
Usualmente me duermo en casa,
Porque se me hace
Menos aburrido
Que mis clases.
Casi siempre me sientes
Entrando por tu cabeza.

Un cubo

En mi cuarto
hay un cubo
de seis colores
que me mira intensamente
pidiéndome que lo resuelva.
Me mira cada vez que paso,
sus colores como fuego
a una polilla.
Es solo un poco
el tiempo que quiere que lo use.
Ese pequeño tiempo
es todo lo que ocupa
para amarrarme en su dedo como si fuera un hilo
atrapando más y más.
Hasta que me doy cuenta
de por qué lo hace.
Está triste, aburrido
De tanto que fue ignorado.
Solo quiere un amigo
Al que él pueda ayudar
con resolverlo.
No hay que temerlo,
pues él solo quiere compañía,
solo un poquito de tiempo.
Es como si sólo
pidiera un poquito.
Ese cubo ya no está triste
pues por fin tiene un amigo
que felizmente lo ayudará a resolverlo.
Ese pequeño cubo
jamás triste volverá a estar.

Procrastination

By Bella
Vedd

I say I'll start my homework soon,
but end up starting far past noon.
The seconds fly, the time passes fast,
and suddenly the deadline is here at last.

I tell myself, "Just one more show,"
then wonder where the minutes go.
My homework stays untouched all day,
while I find other games to play.

I feel stress build up,
I start to panic,
I start to freak,
it's due at the end of the week.

It steals my hours, it steals my time,
I know procrastinating isn't right.
My closest friend, I love and hate,
it seems it's my fate.

This habit makes life tough,
but breaking it is rough.
So here I sit, assignment due,
procrastinating, yeah, that's what I do.

Sisterhood

Ruby Galligan

Sisterhood: a bond
Girls, brought together through genetics
Yet held together through something more.

One, not the same without the other
A circle halfway finished
An ocean, not quite full
A heart, split in two

They may be separated
But never apart.

The anchor always there
Holding you down
Keeping you centered.

Sisterhood can be a lot of things
It can be violent
It can be scary
But it can be so beautiful.

Feeling so attached to another person has only brought me
fear
So dependent on another, making one feel so weak.
It is a scary thing.

I wouldn't trade it for the world.

One person, my one priority
The only person I would run through an airport for,
The only person I would dance in the rain with,
The only person that could make me feel so weak
and so safe at the same time,
The only person that has ever really heard me
And the only person that ever could.

To my other half.



By Gavin Dickson

I'm Rage

Nobody likes me

I always make people scream

And punch each other

I have a bad headache

Because of all the loud noise

I hear people tell each other "shut up"

I have a salty taste in my mouth

Something smells rotten

I see the color red

My family doesn't like me anymore

I hate kids

They make me feel hot

All they do is scream and whine

My wife takes the kids on the weekends

She doesn't like me being around them

My parents stopped talking to me

They say I am unpleasant

I don't get much sleep anymore

I am always angry

When I wake up I already expect to have another
day filled with rage

Falling Beneath the Sun

I have been wrongfully imprisoned.
My whole life reduced to this island
Watching as my father loses his mind
I don't help when he plans to escape
Why should I?

It was his pride that put me here
His inventions, his mistakes

He comes to me with a new idea
His eyes bright with hope
He says this time, this one will work
He begins tying feathers together,
coating them with beeswax
I jump and play with his materials
The wax melts in my hands

He ties the makeshift wings one last time
Declaring them ready
My father, trembling, lifts into the air
My mouth hung a gape
I stare, Breath held tight

Realizing my life could be more than this island, more than him.

I situate myself between the second pair of wings
My father's eyes turned sorrowful
His hands began to tremble
"Take the middle way" he whispers
"Between the extremes"

He wiped his tears stained cheeks, a kiss
He rises higher, graceful, like he's always belonged to the sky

He gestured for me to follow
I kick off the floor
I hover, caught between fear and flight
I follow after my father
Flapping my makeshift wings
I was flying, it felt forbidden
Illegal that many would die without flying
The feeling of being so untethered and free
In the sun, so beautiful

The warm fear of light filling the sky with energy
It's rays dance across the ocean
I never understood It's true beauty
But freedom comes with a cost
The heat is too much
The wax melts
Feather slip away
Carried off by the wind
My wings unravel.

My bare arms, frail as a plummet
Falling faster, closer to the sea.
The Ocean rushes to meet me
I hit the surface with a smack.
The ocean swallows me whole
I call for my father,
No one answers
Water fills my lungs,
My body goes limp.

Before my eyes closed for the last time
I see the sun's light above the surface
As if saying goodbye.

Amor Perdido

(Basado en el poema de Raquel Lanseros.)

Por Camila Tirado

Estoy completamente sola en mi cuarto
y ya me he imaginado varias veces el día de mi muerte...

Un domingo por la tarde me
sumergiré en un lago para reencontrarme con
mi amante fallecido.

¿Por qué?

Porque dos mil cincuenta y siete
manadas de zombies ocupan las calles,
con dientes de perla adornando
sus horripilantes bocas de un color blanco.
Son unos monstruos.

No sonríen, hablan, ni lloran: son estatuas,
cuyo lenguaje no hablo.

Siempre había soñado con un fin tranquilo de planetas en línea.

Siempre quise una muerte a la estatura de la vida y
siempre quise estar con el que mas queria.

Somos demasiados tristes lastimados
y ojalá nada de esto jamás me hubiera pasado.

Again

By Gavin Dickson

BASED ON A POEM BY JERICHO BROWN

I say I will do it but don't
I say I will go to sleep early
But do I?
I don't
I say I will workout
But do I?
I don't
I even say I will get off my phone
But do I?
I don't
I feel upset
I feel annoyed
I broke a promise
I disappoint myself
But I still make the promise
My parents remind me
I try to remind myself
But when the moment comes,
I cancel
I want to break this habit
I doubt myself
I don't trust myself
I take things that I said back
Just to feel good



Childhood

Nostalgia

By: Anonymous

I once was a kid, wild and free,
I chased the wind and I cut my hair with glee.
Unaware of the world around me,
A world I didn't need to please.
The whole world seemed like such a perfect place,
Or so it seemed.

When I was a kid,
I always wished I would grow older.
I believed that growing up
would make life better, cooler, bolder,
I wish I could take back those thoughts.

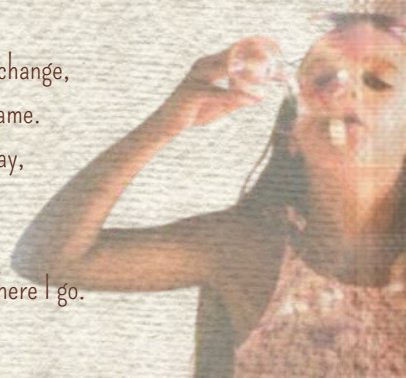
Now time has passed,
Where every week repeats the same,
An endless loop of stress and work.
I ask myself if it's worth the effort,
Yet every-time i know the result.

I wanna be that kid again,
The little kid who never cared about the things she did.
Who never have a second thought,
About the way she looked or the things she bought.

I want to go back,
Back to when things were easy.
I want to be able to experience my childhood again,
And not take it for granted.
I want to be able to sleep soundly at night,
Falling asleep to cartoons,
and dreaming the most whimsical things.

Is this what growing up is?
Leaving things behind over and over again.
Until you eventually make the realization,
That there is no going back.

In the mirror I see the change,
Not feeling quite the same.
But at the end of the day,
she is still inside me,
that freespirited kid,
And I carry her everywhere I go.



La Tormenta

Por: Mila Lopez

Las nubes se tornan negras
Mientras cubren la luz del sol que brillaba con fuerza
El viento agita las palmeras
Pero a mi este clima no me estresa

Las hojas de los árboles se mueven como bailarinas
Dan vuelta y vuelta hasta que caen al piso
Se empiezan a esconder las golondrinas
Al igual que todos los animales, desaparecen como si fuera un hechizo.

Arriba en el cielo hay una fiesta
Primero sale una luz resplandeciente y después un rugido de león
Pues es el rayo que luego cae desesperadamente
Y aunque se vea delgado, es muy potente.

Luego el piso se empieza a manchar
Son gotas de agua que se multiplican
Hasta hacer que los ríos se comienzan a agrandar
Con cada gota que hace "plin plin" la lluvia se vuelve a formar.



Nervios

Por Mila López

Estoy presente cuando te paras a hablar enfrente de un gran grupo de personas. Cuando tus manos no paran de temblar y sudán sin razón. Me meto a tu cabeza para que sobre pienses todo y en tus oídos soy un inquietante zumbido que nunca se apaga. En lo personal, soy pésimo tomando decisiones, se me nublan las ideas y nunca estoy seguro de lo que quiero. En tu boca yo haré que sientas un sabor salado mientras que al hablar, entre cada frase, no pararás de decir “estem..” o “de que”, como si fuera un trabalenguas que no puedes detener. Tengo un fuerte olor a menta y me relacionan mucho con el morado. Al sentirme notarás que mi textura, puntiaguda, no te dejará estar a gusto y solo se detendrá cuando me vaya. Sin importar lo que hagas. Aunque tengo amigos, son muy pocos; me inquieta experimentar cosas nuevas, como hablar con extraños. No me gusta estar solo pero tampoco estar con una multitud. Soy un viejo tembloroso que vive en tu cabeza y aparece en los peores momentos, soy lo que te hace dudar y como ya podrás adivinar, sabrás que soy los nervios.

Eternal Love



(Inspirado por el poema "2059" de Raquel Lanseros.

Por: Paulina P

The condemned are not alone,
We gather in multitudes.
In a place they left us to rot and
disappear,
In hopes of not having to deal with us
anymore.

Our hair is grey, a tangled mess of
what's left
Our bodies slowly rotting
Our faces covered in wrinkles
Our skin soaks and folds
And yellow teeth decorate the mouths
of many.

Here we are what's forgotten,
What is now old and meaningless,
We don't laugh, or cry, we are statues.
I can no longer move, eat or do
anything by myself,
I have become a piece of clutter.

But there was once a time,
Being old wasn't bad.
When I would enjoy it with someone by
my side,
Someone who I promised I'd grow old
with.
Never imagining I'd have to face these
years alone.

And know I'm being dragged into a
bright room,
Like a dog about to be put down.
But I'm no longer scared of this fate,
I've grown to accept it, to embrace it.

I always dreamed of a better death
than this,
One surrounded by loved ones,
And in a large field covered in
colors.
However here I lay know,
In a small colorless room,
With nobody except a stranger with
a syringe,
who will put me to sleep.

As I'm submerged in darkness,
A smile turns on my old, wrinkled
face,
Because I know soon enough we will
be reunited.
And as I rise to the surface, light
breaking through,
I find myself in a blooming field of
flowers,
And they're, by my side, my
deceased husband.
My one eternal love.